

EXAMINED

Saregama Carvaan



Packing 5000 retro songs, the Saregama Carvaan is built to look and feel like an old transistor. That being said, the choice of material and a few elements in the build detract from the old-world feel. The body is made of a shiny plastic material. While the buttons for 'Artistes', 'Moods', 'Geetmala' and a few others retain the click that we associate with the transistor radios of our childhood and before, the rotating knobs, used for scrolling within a classification and volume adjustment, also emulate the scrolling of the older equivalents. We would've loved an old switch-type power button though, just for the sake of perfection.

The Carvaan is meant to appease an older audience. The songs from the yesteryears are divided into classifications like 'Artists', 'Moods' and 'Geetmala', which was a very popular weekly radio countdown on Radio Ceylon, the oldest radio station in Asia. The rotating dial and the navigational buttons are the operational control available, although there is a bit of lag in response.

To provide additional value, the device also has other features to listen to your favourite music, like FM radio,

USB and Bluetooth playback. In those modes, do not expect your bass heavy tracks to retain the same feel, as it is mainly meant for retro Bollywood music. Although, it leaves no complaints in the volume department.

The Carvaan is meant as a novelty gift for the elderly and people who are into retro music of the years gone by. And it fulfils that objective as well as possible, with it very possibly becoming a standard fixture at afternoon tea time at any household that has it.

SPECIFICATIONS

DIMENSIONS: 27cm x 17 cm x 8 cm | **WEIGHT:** 1.5kgs | **BATTERY BACKUP:** Approx 5 hours playtime | **AUDIO JACK:** 3.5mm | **USB:** 2.0 | **CHARGER:** 220V 50Hz, 5V 1A (CE Standard - Indian pin plug) | Comes along with an Android device compatible charger | **PRICE:** ₹5,990/-

iRobot Braava jet 240

From the same company that brought us Roomba, the new iRobot Braava jet 240 is a tiny battery-powered robot that is designed to sweep and mop hard floors like tiles and marbles. The device is equipped with a water spray and a vibrating head that fits in proprietary cleaning pads which are sold separately. There are four different types of Braava Jet Cleaning Pads currently available— Three disposable pads (Dry Sweeping Pad, Damp Sweeping Pad, Wet Sweeping Pad) and a more expensive reusable pad that can be washed.

The Jet is fairly simple to use. It can navigate on its own and create a 'Virtual Wall' to stop itself from entering restricted areas, like adjacent rooms, carpets, etc, features cliff sensors similar to the Roomba, so it can auto-detect stairs or



other such obstacles and avoid them. And there is only one button to initiate/stop all cleaning process. The three different modes (dry sweeping, damp sweeping and wet mopping) are auto-detected by the bot depending on which cleaning pad you use. It also supports Bluetooth connectivity so once you download the iRobot app,

you can use your phone to start or stop a cleaning process, monitor your robot's battery life, check water levels or track which cleaning mode is in progress.

The iRobot Braava Jet is the company's cheapest robot available for ₹19,900 and in the box, you get the robot, a 1950mAh lithium-ion battery with a charger, and 6 disposable cleaning pads (two of each type). The cleaning pads are also sold separately, priced ₹690 for a box of 10 pads while the washable pad is priced at ₹1190 for a box of two. And although this might still seem quite expensive in a price sensitive market like India, if you have the money to spare, the Braava Jet delivers what it is intended for - a clean sweep.

SPECIFICATIONS

ROBOT DIMENSIONS: 6.7 x 7 x 3.3 inches | **ROBOT WEIGHT:** 2.7 lbs. | **PRICE:** ₹19,900/-